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Election Results Force Restructuring Of City's Political Complexion

WILSON WINS FIRST BLACK MAYOR OF OAKLAND



"I never doubted that we were going to win — and I say WE!"

(Oakland, Calif.) - It finally happened! Riding on the crest of an overwhelming flatlands vote from Black and poor communities, Judge Lionel Wilson, quoted above, became the first Black mayor in Oakland's history last Tuesday evening, bringing a new leadership to this multiethnic port city — the promise of a "new day."

It was, in the words of Elaine Brown, "... the first time, not only in this city but in this entire country, that people have put together a 'People's Victory.'"

Or, as Wilson campaign manager Sandre Swanson crowed shortly before the final results were in, unleashing an hours-long expression of unrestrained joy from the packed crowd gathered at the Labor Temple: "We won y'all! Y'all done elected a mayor!!!"

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BLACK PANTHER PARTY CENTRAL HEADQUARTERS



BPINS photos

Aided by a dynamic "get-out-the-vote" drive organized by the Black Panther Party (above, right) and countless other supporters, Judge LIONEL J. WILSON (above, left) has been elected the first Black mayor of Oakland, California.

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